hospital. For others the day began earlier, with the sound of demolition charges blowing up a neighbor's home. Some hurried home in the evenings, fearful of working a night shift. They passed heavily armed Israeli police at seemingly every intersection.

Israeli authorities had wrestled the situation in Jerusalem under control by deploying thousands of extra police, making hundreds of arrests, setting up dozens of checkpoints and roadblocks, and even briefly building a wall around one Palestinian neighborhood. The violence did not entirely stop, and it continued in to pop up in other cities, but the breakneck pace of attacks in Jerusalem was halted.

As with the previous year, most of the attackers had no clear links to political factions, according to Israeli security officials, and no criminal records. Relatives struggled to explain what had happened. "He was a happy boy", said the uncle of a Palestinian teenager who had plunged a knife into an Israeli policeman's neck. "He had a job and a family, a decent life", said a young man whose cousin, a telephone company employee, had hacked a pedestrian to death with a meat cleaver. The crackdown brought calm, but it also reinforced the sense amongst Palestinians that Israel was encroaching ever further into their isolated city. The residents of Sur Baher, a district in the southeast, would queue each day for forty-five minutes at a checkpoint on their way to stock produce shelves and pump gas in West Jerusalem. In Shuafat, a few miles northeast of the Old City, the morning rush could take two hours.

"We live in shit already, and then they come and demolish our homes, put us out on the streets," said Mu'ataz Abu Jamal, a relative of no less than three attackers. "Why should I explain what was in my brother's head?"

The tightest closure was in Issawiya, a rough district of 14,000 people adjacent to the prestigious Hebrew University on Mt. Scopus. Only one road leading out of Issawiya was still open to traffic; the western exits were sealed with concrete blocks, where pedestrians queued for questioning and a thorough search by Israeli border policemen. At one point these restrictions on movement turned into a matter of life and death. Hoda Darwish, 65, developed breathing problems after a tear gas canister landed near her home on 18 October. Her sons tried to drive her to Hadassah hospital, normally a six-minute trip. The journey took forty-five minutes, with a lengthy stop at a checkpoint where Israeli security forces fired shots in the air to subdue the crowd, according to her sons. She died en route.